

# Unit 5 — Media and Democracy

Track E • Klasse 10 • Niveau E



## 1. Vocabulary

Match each item to its meaning or use it in a sentence.

| Term                       | Your note |
|----------------------------|-----------|
| free press                 |           |
| press freedom              |           |
| accountability             |           |
| scrutiny                   |           |
| oversight                  |           |
| opinion vs. reporting      |           |
| editorial independence     |           |
| conflict of interest       |           |
| sponsored content          |           |
| public-interest journalism |           |
| civic information          |           |
| local press desert         |           |

## 2. Reading

Read the text, then answer in full sentences.

*More than 200 local newspapers in the UK have closed in the past two decades. Research has linked their disappearance to lower voter turnout, less scrutiny of local councils and slower response to local environmental issues. The link is not necessarily causal — districts that lose papers are also often districts under broader economic stress — but it is consistent across studies. In some contexts, hyper-local newsletters and citizen journalism have replaced the papers; in others, they have not.*

## 3. Practise

1. Choose hedge: *It has been argued / The evidence suggests / Critics maintain* — \_\_\_ that local papers support voter turnout. \_\_\_ that the link is causal.
2. Match: free press → press freedom; oversight → scrutiny; sponsored content → paid promotion.
3. Build 4 academic-register sentences on the local-press topic.

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## 4. Write

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**Op-ed, 220 words.** Take a position on a media-democracy topic of your choice. Use 4 academic-register hedges + 1 cautious-claim phrase + 1 complex-sentence subordinator.

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Lösungen **Controlled.** 1. The evidence suggests / Critics maintain.

2. all true.

**Productive.** 3. Open.

**T1.** 200+; lower voter turnout / less scrutiny of councils; districts also under economic stress; consistent across studies.

**T2.** lower voter turnout / less scrutiny of councils / slower response on local environment; districts often under broader economic stress; hyper-local newsletters and citizen journalism; in some contexts yes, in others no.

**T3.** The evidence suggests / Critics maintain / In some contexts / Caution is warranted.

**T4.** Open.